Purchasing (PO)

Purchase orders to vendors, receiving, billing, pack POs and purchasing reports.

1. What this module is for

Purchasing is where the company orders material from its vendors and tracks each order until it is received and billed. Buyers write a purchase order, post it so costs and prices are brought up to date, record what arrives, and record what the vendor has invoiced. A pack PO lets the office order the package items of scheduled packs and convert them into one purchase order. Access is controlled per login (permission flag PO).

2. How it connects to other modules

Needs data from

MODULE	WHAT IT USES	WHY
Inventory control	Items (with last and average cost), vendors and vendor prices	Every order line is an inventory item bought from an inventory vendor
Database maintenance (lists)	Companies (ship-to and bill-to, with their sales tax rate), payment terms, divisions, inventory classes	Pick-lists and tax on the order
Job setup and Plan management	Jobs, lots, scheduled packs and the package items in each pack	Used only by pack POs

Feeds data to

MODULE	WHAT IT GIVES	WHEN
Inventory control	Received quantities, which are added to stock; open order quantities, shown as "on order"; updated last cost, average cost, job cost price and VIP, Residential PO and Retail selling prices on the items	Receipts reach stock when Inventory control runs **Update now**. Costs and prices change when you **Post purchase order**.

Where it sits in the work flow

Before: items and vendors exist in Inventory control; reorder needs show on the Inventory reports; scheduled packs exist on lots. During: the buyer creates a PO, adds items, posts it, sends the printed PO to the vendor, then records receipts and billing as the material and invoices arrive. After: Inventory control posts the receipts into stock, and the PO is closed when everything is received and billed.

3. Screens (tabs) in this module

SCREEN / TAB	WHAT IT IS FOR	WHAT YOU CAN DO THERE
Overview	Counts and latest orders	See open orders, back-ordered lines, lines received but not billed, pack POs not converted; open a recent PO; start a new PO
Purchase orders	List of all POs	Search and filter by status, division, vendor and date; open a PO; start a new PO
Purchase order (form)	One PO: header, lines, totals, receiving, billing	Edit the order, post, receive, bill, close, reopen, delete, print
Pack POs	List of pack POs	Filter All, Not converted, Converted; open or start a pack PO
Pack PO (form)	One pack PO	Add scheduled packs, post (convert) to a purchase order
Reports	Purchasing reports	Choose a report tab, filter, export CSV, print

4. How the data entry forms work

New purchase order

- When you use it: to start an order.
- Fields: Vendor (required, type to search); PO date, Ship to, Bill to (pick-lists of companies; the main company is the default), Payment terms (pick-list; "Vendor default" uses the vendor's terms), Notes.
- Step by step: press **New purchase order**, choose the vendor and press **Create purchase order**. The order opens so you can add items.
- What gets saved: the order header, with a new PO number. It appears at once in the list and the Overview.

Purchase order (header, lines and totals)

- When you use it: to build, change, receive and bill an order.
- Fields:
- Header: PO date, Ship to, Bill to, Payment terms, Tax rate % (0 means use the ship-to company's rate, shown in the label), Shipping $, Notes.
- Lines: Item (type to search), Qty, Cost. Cost left empty fills automatically from the vendor's price, then last cost, then average cost.
- Step by step:

1. Change the header and press **Save**.
2. In the last row of the Lines table pick an item, type a quantity (and a cost if you want to override) and press **Add**. The pencil edits quantity and cost; the trash can removes a line that has no receipts or billing.
3. Totals on the right update: Items, Taxable items, Sales tax, Shipping, Total. Items with cost code NT are not taxed.
4. Press **Post purchase order** (see Action buttons).
5. When material arrives, type the quantity in the line's Receive box and press **Rec** (the box suggests the balance). Quantities received are shown with a badge: green when complete, amber when partial, red when more than ordered.
6. When the vendor invoices, type the quantity in the Bill box and press the button beside it. Lists of Receipts and Billing appear below.
7. Press **Print** for the printable PO. Press **Close PO** when finished, or **Reopen** later. A banner offers to close when everything is received and billed.

- What gets saved: the order, its lines, receipts and billing entries. Receipts show as "Waiting" until Inventory control posts them to stock, then "Posted".
- Safeguards: a vendor is required; the date is required; the tax rate must be between 0 and 25; shipping cannot be negative; quantity must be a whole number above 0; the same item cannot be on a PO twice (change its quantity); a closed PO cannot be changed until reopened; a line cannot be removed once it has receipts or billing; a receipt that has been posted to inventory cannot be deleted; a PO with receipts or billing cannot be deleted (close it instead). Deleting, removing lines, receipts and billing entries all ask for confirmation. A message tells you when more than the ordered quantity is received.

Pack PO

- When you use it: to order the package items of packs scheduled on lots, from one vendor.
- Fields: Vendor (required), Date, Ship to, Bill to, Terms, Shipping $, Notes. Lines: choose a Job, Lot and one of that lot's scheduled packs, plus Quantity and Cost (0 uses the last cost).
- Step by step: press **New pack PO**, choose the vendor, and create it. Add each lot and pack with **Add pack**. The table shows how many package items each pack contains ("none" means that pack produces no order lines). Change quantity or cost in the table, remove a line with the trash can, then press **Post pack PO**.
- What gets saved: on posting, one new purchase order is created for the vendor, with one line per item (quantities added up across all packs), and posted like any PO. The pack PO is marked with the conversion date and a link to the new PO.
- Safeguards: the same lot and pack cannot be added twice; the pack must be scheduled on the chosen lot; posting asks for confirmation and can only be done once; a converted pack PO cannot be changed or deleted; posting is refused if none of the packs contain package items. All or nothing.

5. Reports

REPORT	WHAT IT SHOWS	FILTERS YOU CHOOSE FIRST	PRINT / EXPORT
Back ordered	Lines on open POs ordered but not fully received	From (defaults to one year ago), To, Division, Vendor	CSV and Print buttons
Received, not billed	Lines received but not fully billed, to match with vendor invoices	Same	CSV and Print
Overages	Lines where more was received than ordered	Same	CSV and Print
All PO lines	Every PO line with ordered, received and billed quantities and cost	Same	CSV and Print
Totals	PO count, line count and value by vendor, division or class	Same; By vendor, By division or By class	CSV and Print
Price fluctuation	Items bought at different prices, with lowest, highest, average and the spread	Same	CSV and Print

PO numbers in the line reports are links that open the order.

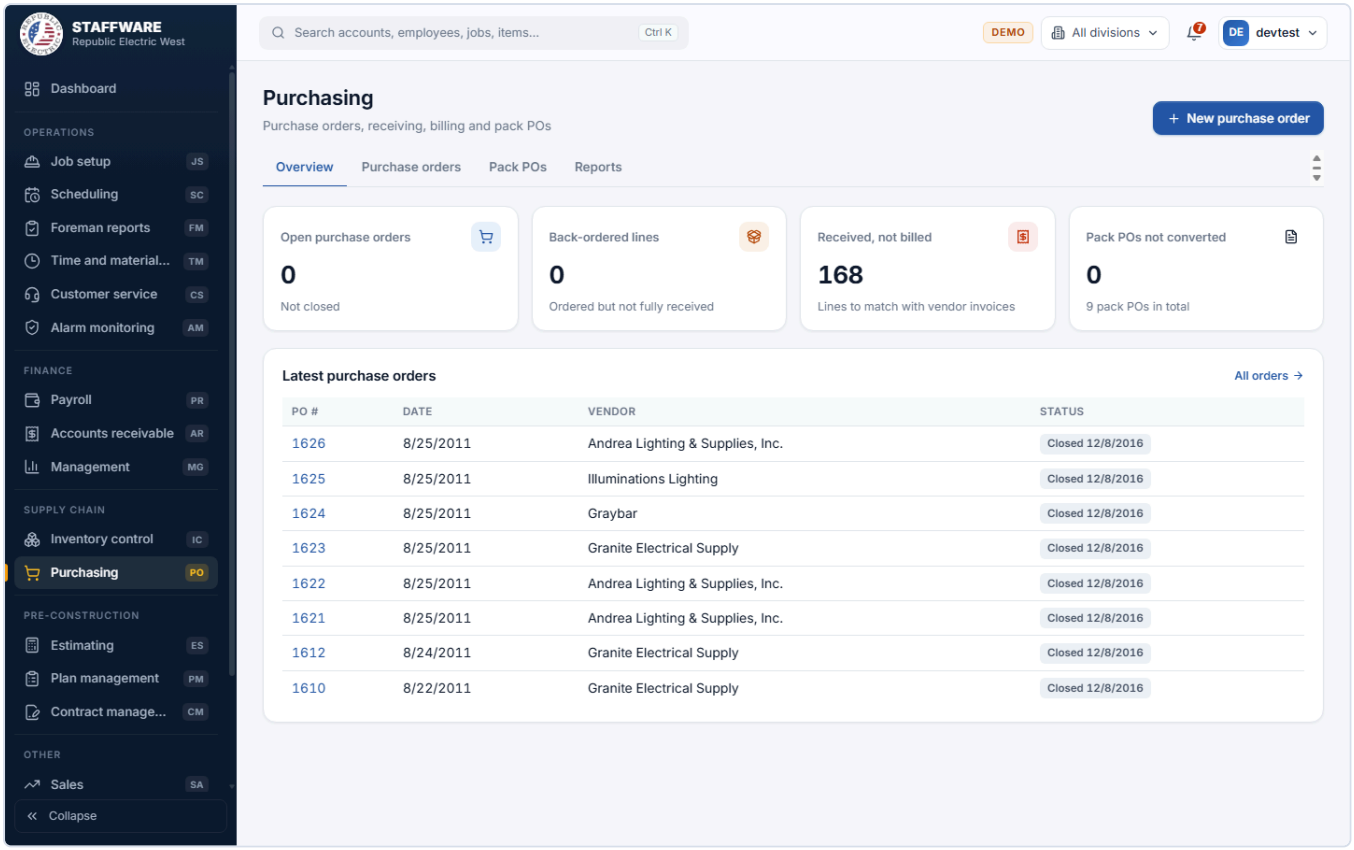
6. Action buttons

BUTTON	WHERE	WHAT IT DOES	WHAT CHANGES	SAFEGUARDS
Post purchase order	Purchase order	Fills zero costs from last or average cost; sets each item's last cost and last purchase date; works out the tax rate and tax amount; recalculates each item's average cost from the last 365 days of orders; updates job cost price for items set to update automatically; recalculates the VIP, Residential PO and Retail selling prices from the mark-ups	Updates the PO and the item records in Inventory control	Confirmation lists what will change. Needs at least one line. Blocked on a closed PO. All or nothing.
Receive all balances	Purchase order	Receives the unreceived balance of every line, dated today	Adds receipts, which wait for Inventory control to post	Confirmation. Blocked on a closed PO.
Bill everything received	Purchase order	Marks all received but unbilled quantities as billed, dated today	Adds billing entries	Confirmation
Close PO / Reopen	Purchase order	Sets or clears the closed date	Closed POs cannot be edited and drop out of "open" counts	None needed; can be reversed
Post pack PO	Pack PO	Converts the pack PO into a purchase order	Creates and posts a PO; marks the pack PO converted	Confirmation; once only

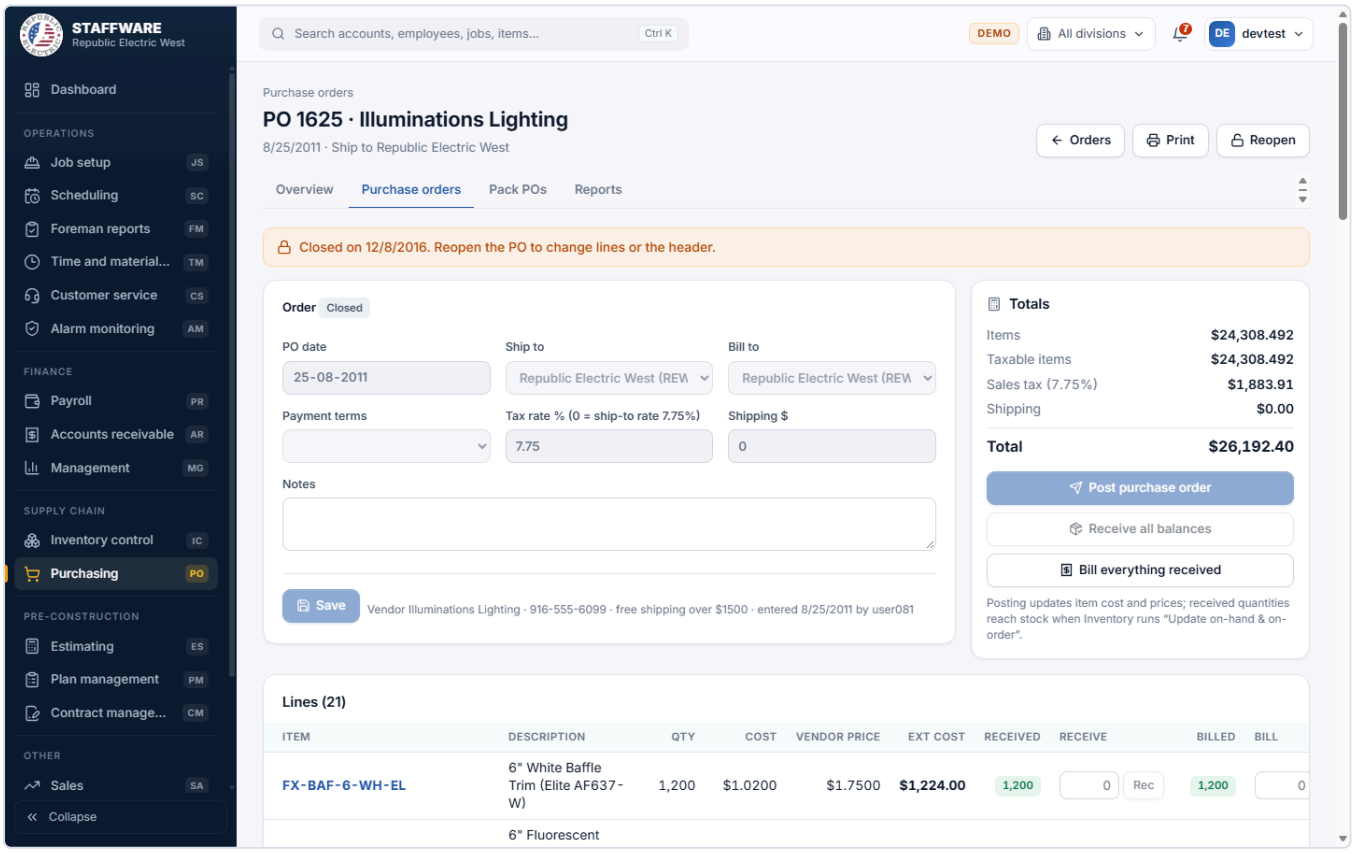
7. A typical day-to-day workflow

1. Check **Inventory control > Reports > Need to order** and the **Purchasing > Overview** counts.
2. Press **New purchase order**, choose the vendor, ship-to and terms.
3. Add items; check the vendor price, quantities and totals.
4. Press **Post purchase order**; then **Print** and send the PO to the vendor.
5. When material arrives, open the PO and record receipts (**Rec**, or **Receive all balances**).
6. In Inventory control press **Update now** so the receipts reach stock.
7. When the vendor invoice arrives, record billing, or press **Bill everything received**.
8. Review **Reports > Back ordered** and **Received, not billed** each week.
9. Close the PO. For builder-supplied package items, use **Pack POs** to order several lots at once.

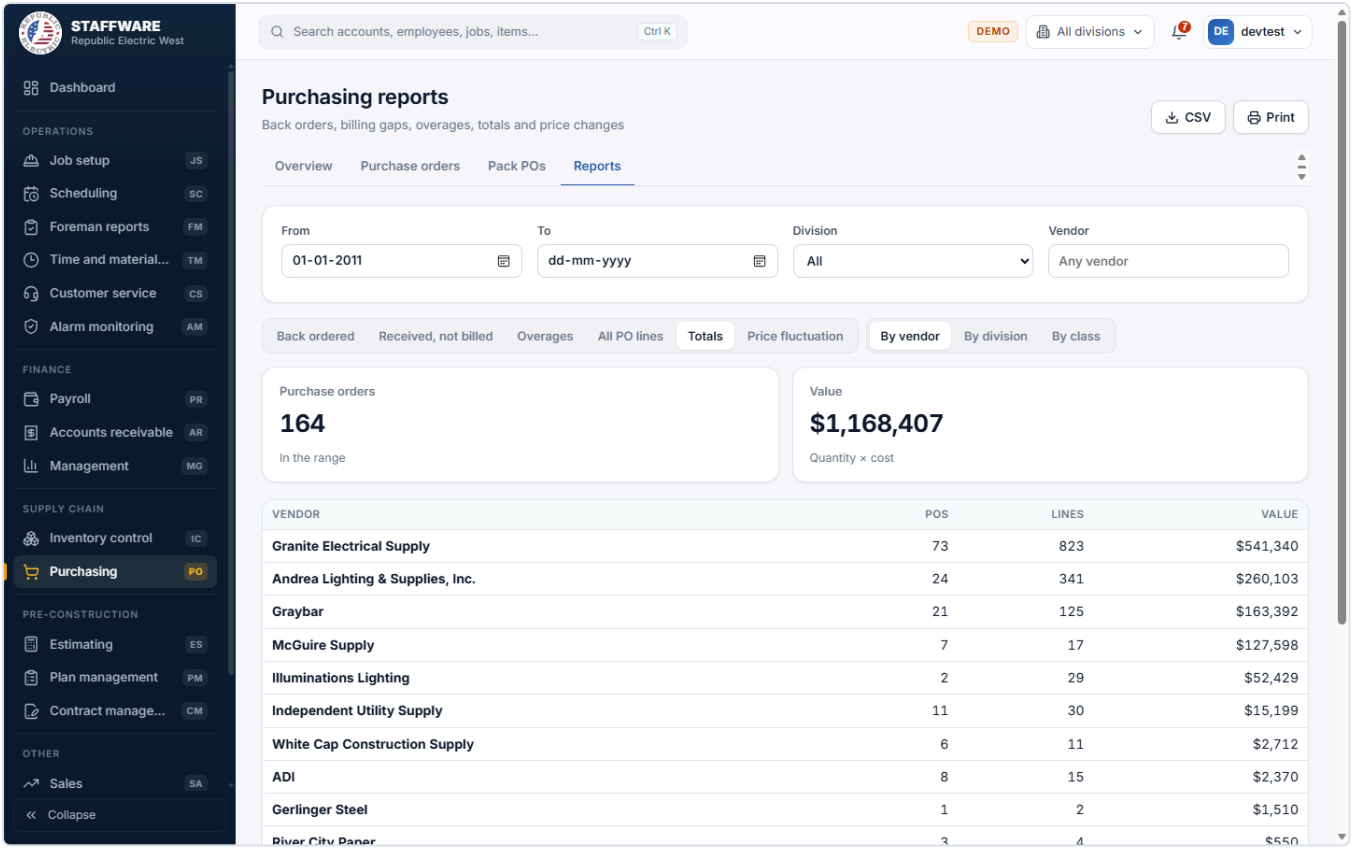
8. Screenshots



Purchasing overview with open orders, back-ordered and unbilled lines



A purchase order with header, totals, receiving and billing columns



Purchasing totals by vendor report

9. Good to know

- The order, receiving, billing and pack PO screens follow the Access Purchase order, Receive PO material, Billed PO material and Post pack PO processes. Totals and tax follow the Access rules.
- Receiving on a PO does not change stock by itself. Stock changes when Inventory control posts it.
- Vendors and items are maintained in Inventory control, not here.
- Not built in this module (found in the Access switchboard): Item research, Material order estimate, PO item history export, Update item prices, Low estimating prices, Items with zero value, and Vendor categories. Vendor categories are a list kept in Database maintenance. Check with the project owner before promising the others.
- Printing a PO uses a dedicated PO page; reports use the browser print button and CSV export.
- The demo data has no open purchase orders, so the screenshots show a closed order.